

Pleasure

This is more about those fleeting moments of joy and satisfaction that we usually associate with the word 'happy', and finding more ways to build these small moments into our everyday lives. They give us something to look forward to, and can have a halo effect on everything else, colouring even the mundane but necessary moments of life with their glow. Take something that gives you that little moment of release and think about where you might be able to duplicate that feeling throughout your day or week. It might be the first sip that you take of your coffee in the morning, or the rush of wind in your hair when you cycle down a hill, or a proper belly laugh at a favourite TV show.

If you're concerned about finding time for these moments, can you use them to replace the times when you do things mindlessly? Can you catch yourself when you're 'doom scrolling' Twitter, and tell yourself 'enough'? Saying, 'That's enough, I'm going to do something that gives me pleasure now' shouldn't be a radical act, but it often feels like it is. We can shy away from pleasure, especially if we feel undeserving of it, but it's so, so important. The more pleasure we are able to squeeze out of the little moments of our lives, the less we need to tell ourselves that we'll be happy when we finally get that dress, those shoes, that car, that house.

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